

Chapter 80-1

Zhao Xuning's words made Liang Shi momentarily stunned.

A moment later, Liang Shi took out her keys to open the door. She smiled casually, "I'm really liking you more and more."

Zhao Xuning: "?"

"Don't." Zhao Xuning said, "I have no interest in you."

Liang Shi glanced at her: "What are you thinking? I mean the kind of liking where I admire you."

Zhao Xuning: "...It's still best if you don't."

The security here was particularly good—the building entrance required facial recognition or fingerprint, and the apartment door used a key plus facial or fingerprint recognition. This double security system put Liang Shi completely at ease.

After the facial recognition, Liang Shi pushed open the door and found that the place was cleaner and brighter than before. The smell inside was also much better, without the dusty scent of a long-unoccupied space that she had noticed during her previous visit.

Zhao Xuning must have had someone clean it.

Liang Shi brought in her and Xu Qingzhu's suitcases while teasing Zhao Xuning, "Dr. Zhao, you're really too thoughtful."

"No." Zhao Xuning had her hands stuffed in her coat pockets, her expression cold. She reached up to adjust her glasses, looking every bit like an aloof beauty.¹ "I'm the landlord, and you need to pay me rent, so having someone clean the apartment is perfectly normal. There's no need to develop feelings for me because of this."

Liang Shi: "..."

She looked at Zhao Xuning: "Dr. Zhao, do you have some kind of psychological trauma about making friends?"

Zhao Xuning pressed her lips together and lifted her chin toward the living room. "Hurry up and get things sorted. There's still things to do."

Before tidying up, Liang Shi first made a phone call to Zhou Li, saying she had some matters to attend to today and would come in the afternoon to do the handover work. The higher-ups had already approved her resignation.

Zhou Li then asked if she had time tonight.

After thinking about it, Liang Shi replied, "Yes, I do."

"Everyone wants to throw you a farewell party, treat you to dinner and karaoke." Zhou Li said.

Liang Shi chuckled softly, "Alright."

After hanging up, Zhao Xuning said in a flat tone, "You're quite popular at the company."

Liang Shi raised an eyebrow: "Of course. Aren't you?"

Zhao Xuning: "...Working at a hospital, professional competence is more important than popularity."

Liang Shi: "..."

Was it that hard to tell the truth?

But then again, Liang Shi felt she couldn't understand the world of geniuses.

Just like how Xu Qingzhu even had to compete with her when it came to waking up.

She simply couldn't understand any of it.

Liang Shi felt that among all these highly ambitious and driven people, she seemed like a salted fish² in comparison.

But clearly! She used to work very hard too!

What puzzled Liang Shi even more was that in the ABO worldview setting, Alphas generally had greater physical strength and intelligence than Omegas, and Omegas were stronger than Betas.

Of course, this was also a matter of probability.

What was rarest of all was that Xu Qingzhu, as an Omega, was both so beautiful and had such high intelligence.

Perhaps her only shortcoming was physical stamina.

Liang Shi secretly thought it was a pity.

However, she only briefly pondered this question.

After all, this world was created by an author, with countless personal settings and possible logical bugs. As long as things could be wrapped up to let it end, and the Alpha female lead and the Omega female lead could be together, that was enough.

A romance-driven novel—wasn't it just about being lovey-dovey and romantic?

What more could you ask for?³

Liang Shi even momentarily felt that she was here to fix the author's logical bugs, considering the crazy character content here was seriously off the charts.

But as the novel's female lead, Xu Qingzhu was indeed perfect with no flaws.

"What are you thinking about?" Zhao Xuning waved her hand in front of Liang Shi's face. "Is the view outside that captivating?"

"It's actually not bad." Liang Shi came back to her senses and only then realized she had been staring out at the river view, lost in thought. "Dr. Zhao, is your university near here?"

Zhao Xuning nodded: "Yes."

"Is there any good food at your university?" Liang Shi said, "Can you recommend some to me?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

Although Zhao Xuning tried to keep her tone as flat as possible, Liang Shi could still detect the disdain in that casual tone: "Is that a question a female celebrity should be asking?"

Liang Shi: "...I'm not one yet."

"Aren't you joining the production crew next week?" Zhao Xuning said, "My cousin never eats fried or puffed snacks in the week before filming starts, and she doesn't eat anything after 5 PM. Among all the food near the university district, there's nothing a female celebrity can eat."

Liang Shi: "..."

"I'm getting it for Xu Qingzhu to eat." Liang Shi said, "Don't you think she's too thin?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

After two seconds of silence, Zhao Xuning said: "I don't think so."

Liang Shi was speechless. She suddenly understood why Dr. Zhao had no friends.

Dr. Zhao's EQ⁴ must have been sacrificed to subsidize her IQ. But then again, Liang Shi actually thought she was quite genuine this way.

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1. "Aloof beauty" (高嶺之花, gāolǐng zhī huā) — literally "flower on a high peak," a Chinese/Japanese expression referring to someone beautiful but unapproachable, like a flower growing on a mountain peak that's too high to reach. ↵
 2. "Salted fish" (鹹魚, xiányú) — Chinese internet slang for someone who has no ambition or motivation and just wants to lie around doing nothing, like a dead fish that's been salted for preservation. ↵
 3. "What more could you ask for?" — The original phrase is "還要什麼自行車?" (literally "what more, a bicycle?"), a Chinese internet slang expression meaning "what more do you want?" or "don't be greedy." It comes from a comedy sketch and implies someone should be satisfied with what they have. ↵
 4. "EQ" — Emotional Quotient, referring to emotional intelligence. ↵